

Carolina Brañas

Data Scientist

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Data scientist with hands-on experience building machine learning and NLP models, designing scalable data workflows, and turning complex data into actionable insights. Interests: machine learning, network analysis, natural language processing, geospatial data.

EXPERIENCE

- Data Science Research Assistant** *University of Copenhagen, Denmark* **Feb 2026 – Present**
↪ Prof. Asger Mose Wingender
 - Research assistant on the Cataloguing Crop Traits and Breeders Across the OECD 1980–2025 project (financed by the **Carlsberg Foundation**).
 - Building the first large unified database of all new cereal varieties released in the OECD since 1980 – their traits, breeding history, and the companies that developed them – to study how the crop innovation system can raise global food supply without expanding cropland.
 - Manage a student assistant on the project, coordinating and reviewing their work.
- Data Science Research Assistant** *University of Copenhagen, Denmark* **May 2024 – Dec 2025**
↪ Prof. Jeanet Bentzen
 - Contributed to the **Shocking Religion** project on religion’s economic impact, within a multidisciplinary research team.
 - Built topic models to uncover thematic trends in text data, and RAG-based LLM pipelines for document insights.
 - Computed distances from locations to potential earthquake danger areas for each of the four hazard levels (1–4), using Rasterio, GeoPandas and QGIS.
 - Designed and containerized scalable data workflows; handled large-scale data ingestion and preprocessing; deployed on cloud infrastructure (UCloud).
- Data Scientist** *Above Sports, Denmark* **Oct 2023 – May 2024**
 - Developed computer vision models for brand logo detection.
 - Automated data workflows and worked with product teams to refine output quality.
- Marketing Strategist** *Crescendo Collective, United States* **Sep 2021 – May 2022**
 - Analyzed campaign data (Google Analytics, Google Ads) and automated internal reporting with Python.
 - Ran competitor analysis and audience insights with the data team; presented reports to clients and stakeholders.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Social Data Science** **2022 – 2024**
University of Copenhagen, Denmark
Thesis: **Mobility and income segregation in Madrid, Spain.**
Electives: Advanced Machine Learning for Data Science, Geospatial Data Science, Advanced Network Science (ITU); Natural Language Processing (DIKU).
- B.Sc. Marketing, Computer Science Minor** **2018 – 2022**
Cardinal Stritch University, United States
Honours: Magna Cum Laude, Dean’s List (2018–2022), best graduating GPA of Marketing B.Sc. (2022).

SKILLS

- Programming & Data:** Python (pandas, numpy, pytorch, tensorflow, scikit-learn), SQL, Bash, L^AT_EX
- Machine Learning & NLP:** Transformers, topic modeling (UMAP, HDBSCAN, BERTopic), Hugging Face, Weights & Biases, deep learning, predictive modeling, feature engineering, computer vision
- Analysis, Visualization & Geospatial:** statistical analysis, data wrangling, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Tableau, Power BI, Geopandas, Rasterio, QGIS
- Cloud & DevOps:** Docker, Git, Linux, AWS, Azure, UCloud, CI/CD
- Languages:** Spanish (native), Galician (native), English (professional proficiency), Danish (beginner)

AWARDS

- Dean’s List** every semester of the B.Sc., for a GPA above 3.5 **2018–2022**
- Best Graduating GPA of Marketing B.Sc.** highest GPA in Marketing, class of 2022 **2022**
- Academic and Athletic Grant** full four-year scholarship for academic excellence and soccer **2018–2022**